

Employee Benefits Guide

Northwind Traders, Inc. | Human Resources | Plan Year: 2026 | Version 3.0 | Policy Owner: Director, Total Rewards

1. Overview

Northwind Traders offers a comprehensive benefits package to all employees scheduled to work 30+ hours per week. Coverage begins on the first day of the month following 30 days of employment.

2. Health Insurance

Employees may choose from three medical plan tiers, each administered by Meridian Health Group. Dental and vision coverage are bundled at no additional cost for the Silver and Gold tiers.

Plan Tier	Employee Monthly Cost	Employer Contribution	Deductible (Individual)
Bronze	\$45	70%	\$2,500
Silver	\$95	80%	\$1,200
Gold	\$160	90%	\$500

3. Retirement Savings — 401(k)

The Company matches 100% of employee contributions up to 4% of eligible compensation, and 50% of the next 2%, for a maximum match of 5%. Matching contributions vest over 3 years on a graded schedule (33% per year).

4. Life & Disability Insurance

- Basic life insurance: 1x annual salary, paid fully by the Company.
- Supplemental life insurance: employee-paid, up to 5x salary.
- Short-term disability: 60% of salary for up to 12 weeks, Company-paid.
- Long-term disability: 60% of salary after a 90-day elimination period.

5. Wellness Program

Employees may claim up to \$600 per year toward gym memberships, fitness equipment, or wellness apps through the WellNorth reimbursement portal. The Employee Assistance Program (EAP) provides confidential counseling — up to 6 free sessions per issue, per year — through CareLine Partners at 1-800-555-0142.

6. Tuition Reimbursement

Employees may be reimbursed up to \$5,250 per calendar year for job-related coursework and certifications, provided a grade of B or higher (or Pass, for pass/fail courses) is achieved and the course is pre-approved by the employee's manager and People Operations.

7. Additional Perks

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- Commuter benefits: pre-tax transit and parking accounts up to the IRS monthly limit.
 - Remote work stipend: \$50/month toward home internet for hybrid/remote employees.
 - Employee stock purchase plan: 15% discount, two 6-month offering periods per year.
 - Annual learning stipend: \$1,000 for conferences, books, or online courses.

8. Enrollment

Open enrollment runs each year from November 1–15 for coverage effective January 1. Outside of open enrollment, changes are permitted only following a qualifying life event (marriage, birth/adoption, loss of other coverage, etc.), reported within 30 days of the event.

9. Contact

Benefits questions: **benefits@northwindtraders.example** or the Benefits hotline at 1-800-555-0199.